



PawVital

PET HEALTH & WELLNESS

COMPLETE STORE SETUP MANUAL

Your **Shopify** Store From Zero to Live

A beginner-friendly, step-by-step guide to building your PawVital store — adding products, creating collections, setting up menus, configuring your homepage, and going live. No prior Shopify experience needed.

Products & Variants

Collections

Navigation Menus

Homepage Setup

Pages & Blog

Store Settings

Matrixify (Optional)

Theme: PawVital v14

Platform: Shopify OS 2.0

Difficulty: Beginner

Table of Contents

1	Shopify Admin — Getting Your Bearings Overview of the dashboard, key sections, and how to navigate	3
2	Adding Products Title, description, images, pricing, variants, and inventory	4
3	Creating Collections Manual collections, smart (auto) collections, and collection images	6
4	Setting Up Navigation Menus Main menu, footer menu, adding links and sub-links	8
5	Creating Pages About, Contact, FAQ, Shipping policy and custom pages	9
6	Setting Up the Blog Creating blog posts and managing the PawVital Blog	10
7	Homepage Setup in the Customizer Hero, categories, featured products, testimonials, footer	11
8	Store Settings Shipping, payments, taxes, email, and domain	14
9	Matrixify Bulk Import Optional Skip manual entry — import everything at once with one Excel file	15
10	Go-Live Checklist Everything to verify before sharing the store with customers	17

Shopify Admin — Getting Your Bearings

Your Shopify Admin is at your-store.myshopify.com/admin. This is where you manage everything.

The Left Sidebar — Your Main Menu

Menu Item	What it's for
Home	Dashboard with sales overview and quick actions
Orders	View and manage customer orders
Products	Add, edit products and manage collections
Customers	View customer accounts and contact info
Analytics	Sales reports, traffic, and conversion stats
Marketing	Discount codes, email campaigns
Online Store	Theme, pages, blog posts, navigation, and preferences
Settings	Store info, payments, shipping, taxes, and more

Key Areas You'll Use Most

Products Section

Everything under **Products** in the sidebar:

- ✓ Products — add/edit items
- ✓ Collections — group products
- ✓ Inventory — stock levels
- ✓ Gift cards

Online Store Section

Everything under **Online Store**:

- ✓ Themes — install & customize
- ✓ Blog posts — articles
- ✓ Pages — static pages
- ✓ Navigation — menus
- ✓ Preferences — SEO, password

Bookmark tip: Open your Shopify Admin in one tab and your live storefront in another. After making changes, refresh the storefront tab to see them instantly.

Understanding the Theme Customizer

The Customizer is a visual editor for your homepage and theme settings. To open it:

[Online Store](#) → [Themes](#) → [Customize](#)

The Customizer has:

- ✓ **Left panel** — list of sections you can click to edit
- ✓ **Center preview** — live preview of your homepage
- ✓ **Top bar** — switch between Desktop / Mobile / Tablet view
- ✓ **Save button** — always click Save after making changes

Important: Changes in the Customizer are NOT saved automatically. Always click the **Save** button at the top right before leaving.

Adding Products

Products are the core of your store. Follow these steps to add each product manually.

Products → Add product

Step-by-Step: Add a Product

1 Product title

Enter the product name, e.g. *"Hip & Joint Chews for Dogs"*. Keep it clear and searchable.

2 Description

Write a description using the rich text editor. Use bullet points for key ingredients or benefits. This text appears in the product page accordion.

3 Add images

Drag & drop product photos into the *Media* section.

Recommended: 1000×1000px square, JPG or PNG.

The first image becomes the main photo.

4 Set pricing

Enter the

Price

. Optionally enter a

Compare-at price

(the original price shown crossed out — creates a "Sale" badge automatically).

5 Inventory & SKU

Enter a

SKU

(your internal code, e.g. **PV-JOINT-30**). Set *Track quantity* and enter stock count. If you don't track inventory, uncheck it.

6 Shipping weight

Under *Shipping*, enter the product weight. This is used to calculate shipping rates at checkout.

7 Add variants (if needed)

If your product comes in different sizes or flavors, scroll to *Variants* → click

Add options like size or color

→ enter option name (e.g. "Size") and values (e.g. "30 count, 90 count").

8 Add product tags

Tags are used by Smart Collections to auto-group products. Add relevant tags separated by commas, e.g.

joint, supplement, dog, senior .

9 Set product type & vendor

In the right sidebar, enter *Product type* (e.g. **Supplement**) and *Vendor* (e.g. **PawVital**).

10 Save the product

Click

Save

at the top right. The product is now live if your store is published.

Recommended Tags for PawVital Products

Product	Tags to Add
Hip & Joint Chews	joint , supplement , dog , mobility
Feline Calm Drops	calm , supplement , cat , anxiety
Omega-3 Skin & Coat Oil	skin , supplement , coat , dog
Probiotic Digestive Chews	digestion , supplement , gut , dog
Immune Boost Mushroom Blend	immune , supplement , dog
Dental Fresh Sticks	dental , dog , grooming
Calming Anxiety Wrap	calm , wellness , anxiety , dog
Starter Wellness Bundle	bundle , bestseller , new

Tip: Tags are case-sensitive in Smart Collection rules. Use all lowercase and be consistent — **joint** not **Joint** .

Creating Collections

Collections group products together. There are two types: **Manual** (you pick products) and **Smart / Automated** (products added automatically by rules).

Products → Collections → Create collection

Type 1 — Manual Collection

You choose exactly which products appear. Good for: *Best Sellers, Bundles, Sale, New Arrivals*.

1 Enter collection title

E.g. *"Best Sellers"* or *"Bundles & Sets"*.

2 Set Collection type to Manual

Under *Collection type*, select

Manual

.

3 Add products

Scroll to the *Products* section → click

Browse

→ search for and select products → click

Add

.

4 Add a collection image

Scroll to *Collection image* → click

Add image

→ upload a photo.

Recommended: 800×800px.

5 Save

Click

Save

. The collection is now live at **/collections/best-sellers** .

Type 2 — Smart (Automated) Collection

Products are added automatically based on rules like tags, price, or product type. Good for: *Joint & Mobility, Calm & Anxiety, Supplements, Dental*.

1 Enter collection title

E.g. *"Joint & Mobility"*.

2 Set Collection type to Automated

Under *Collection type*, select

Automated

.

3 Add a condition / rule

Click

Add condition

→ select *Product tag* → *is equal to* → type **joint**. Products tagged **joint** will appear here automatically.

4 Add collection image & save

Upload an image and click

Save

.

All Collections to Create for PawVital

Collection Name	Type	Rule / Products
Joint & Mobility	Smart	Tag = joint
Calm & Anxiety	Smart	Tag = calm
Skin & Coat	Smart	Tag = skin
Digestion & Gut	Smart	Tag = digestion
Immune Support	Smart	Tag = immune
Supplements	Smart	Product type = Supplement
Dental	Smart	Tag = dental
Wellness	Smart	Tag = wellness
Best Sellers	Manual	Hand-pick top products
New Arrivals	Manual	Hand-pick newest products
Bundles & Sets	Smart	Tag = bundle
Sale	Smart	Compare-at price > 0
Food & Treats	Smart	Product type = Food
All Products	Smart	No conditions (shows everything)

Tip: Create all collections **after** adding products. Smart collections only populate when matching products already exist.

Setting Up Navigation Menus

Menus control what links appear in your header and footer. You need to set up two menus: **Main menu** and **Footer menu**.

Online Store → Navigation

Setting Up the Main Menu

1 Click "Main menu"

You'll see Shopify's default links. Delete any you don't need by clicking the trash icon.

2 Add a menu item — click "Add menu item"

Enter a *Name* (what shows in the nav) and a *Link* (where it goes).

3 Link to a collection

In the Link field, click the dropdown → select *Collections* → choose your collection. E.g. Link "Shop" to *All Products*.

4 Add sub-menu items (dropdown)

Drag a menu item slightly to the right to make it a child of the item above. This creates a dropdown sub-menu.

5 Save menu

Click

Save menu

. Your changes are live immediately.

Recommended Main Menu Structure

≡ Main Menu

● Home → /

● Shop → /collections/all ↳ has sub-items (see below)

● Joint & Mobility → /collections/joint-mobility

● Calm & Anxiety → /collections/calm-anxiety

● Supplements → /collections/supplements

● Best Sellers → /collections/best-sellers

● About → /pages/about

● Contact → /pages/contact

Setting Up the Footer Menu

Go back to Navigation → click **Footer menu** (or create a new menu named "Footer menu").

Column Group	Links to Add
SHOP	Supplements, Food & Treats, Wellness, Grooming, Bundles, Sale
LEARN	Our Science, Ingredient Glossary, The PawVital Blog, Dosage Guide, Reviews
SUPPORT	Contact Us, Shipping & Returns, Subscriptions, Track Order, FAQ

The PawVital theme's footer automatically reads the **Footer menu** and displays links. The column groupings (SHOP, LEARN, SUPPORT) are set in the Footer section of the Customizer.

Creating Pages

Pages are static content pages like About Us, Contact, FAQ, and policy pages. Create these before setting up your navigation.

Online Store → Pages → Add page

Pages to Create for PawVital

Page Title	URL Handle	Content Tips
About Us	<code>/pages/about</code>	Brand story, mission, vet credentials, team photo
Contact Us	<code>/pages/contact</code>	Email, phone, hours, response time note
FAQ	<code>/pages/faq</code>	Common questions about dosing, safety, returns
Shipping & Returns	<code>/pages/shipping-returns</code>	Delivery times, free shipping threshold, 30-day return policy
Subscriptions	<code>/pages/subscriptions</code>	How Subscribe & Save works, pause/cancel info
Dosage Guide	<code>/pages/dosage-guide</code>	Weight-based dosing table for each product

Step-by-Step: Create a Page

- 1 Enter the page title**
E.g. "About Us". Shopify auto-generates the URL handle (slug) from the title.
- 2 Write the content**
Use the rich text editor. You can add headings (H2, H3), bold text, bullet lists, and links. The PawVital theme styles these beautifully with proper spacing.
- 3 Set visibility**
Under *Visibility* on the right, set to **Visible** so the page is publicly accessible.
- 4 Save**
Click **Save**.
The page is now live at its URL (e.g. `/pages/about`).
- 5 Add the page to your menu**
Go to Online Store → Navigation → Main menu or Footer menu → Add menu item → Link → Pages → select your page.

Contact page tip: The Contact Us page in the demo has pre-written content with Customer Service info. You can copy that content structure and replace the placeholder details with real ones.

Policy Pages (Auto-generated by Shopify)

Shopify can auto-generate policy pages (Privacy Policy, Terms of Service, Refund Policy) under:

Settings → **Policies**

Click **Create from template** for each policy, edit as needed, and Save. These are separate from regular pages and appear in the checkout footer automatically.

Setting Up the Blog

The blog builds trust and drives organic traffic. PawVital uses a blog called "PawVital Blog".

Online Store → Blog posts → Create blog post

Step-by-Step: Create a Blog Post

- 1

Enter the post title

E.g. "5 Signs Your Dog Needs a Joint Supplement".
- 2

Write the content

Use headings (H2, H3), paragraphs, and bullet lists. Aim for 400–800 words per article.
- 3

Add a featured image

On the right side, click *Featured image* → upload.
Recommended: 1200×630px.
This image appears in blog listing pages and social previews.
- 4

Select or create a blog

Under *Blog* on the right → select
PawVital Blog
. If it doesn't exist yet, type "PawVital Blog" and click *Create a new blog "PawVital Blog"*.
- 5

Add tags

Add topic tags like **dogs** , **joints** , **supplements** . These help with filtering on the blog page.
- 6

Set visibility and publish

Set to
Visible
and click
Save
. The post is live immediately at **/blogs/pawvital-blog/post-title** .

Suggested Starter Blog Posts

Title	Topic / Tags
5 Signs Your Dog Needs a Joint Supplement	dogs, joints, mobility
How to Calm an Anxious Cat Naturally	cats, calm, anxiety
The Difference Between Omega-3 for Pets and Humans	supplements, nutrition, skin
Why Vet-Formulated Matters for Pet Supplements	vets, safety, quality

The blog page URL is [/blogs/pawvital-blog](#) . Link to it from your footer menu under the LEARN column.

Homepage Setup in the Customizer

Once products, collections, and pages exist, configure the homepage sections. Open the Customizer:

Online Store → Themes → Customize

Do this last — the Customizer sections need products and collections to already exist so you can link to them.

Section 1 — Announcement Bar

The green bar at the very top of every page. Click it in the left panel to edit.

Field	Suggested Content
Message 1	Free shipping over \$49
Message 2	Vet-formulated, always
Message 3	Subscribe & save 15%

Section 2 — Header

Click **Header** in the left panel.

- ✓ **Logo image** — upload your logo (PNG with transparent background, ~200×60px)
- ✓ **Menu** — select *Main menu*
- ✓ **Mega menu featured image** — upload a lifestyle pet photo (400×260px)
- ✓ **Featured title/subtitle/CTA** — e.g. "Starter Kit" / "Joint + Calm + Gut" / "Shop the kit"
- ✓ **Featured link** — set to `/collections/bundles`

Section 3 — Hero (Main Banner)

The large banner at the top of the homepage.

Field	What to Enter
Hero image	Upload a lifestyle pet photo — dog or cat with product. Recommended: 1400×900px.
Eyebrow text	<i>"Trusted by 50,000+ pet parents"</i>
Heading	<i>"Give Your Pet the Best Years of Their Life"</i>
Subtext	<i>"Vet-formulated supplements designed for real results."</i>
Primary button text	<i>"Shop Supplements"</i>

Field	What to Enter
Primary button link	/collections/supplements
Secondary button text	"Learn Our Science"
Secondary button link	/pages/about

Section 4 — Featured Categories

The row of category tiles with icons. Select up to 6 collections.

- ✓ Joint & Mobility
- ✓ Calm & Anxiety
- ✓ Skin & Coat
- ✓ Digestion & Gut
- ✓ Immune Support
- ✓ Dental

Section 5 — Featured Collection

A grid showing products from one collection.

- ✓ **Collection** — select *Best Sellers* or *All Products*
- ✓ **Heading** — e.g. "*Best Sellers*"
- ✓ **View all link** — [/collections/best-sellers](#)

Section 6 — Benefit Band

A two-column section with a photo on one side and benefit points on the other.

Field	Suggested Content
Image	Happy pet lifestyle photo, 900×900px
Eyebrow	"Why PawVital"
Heading	"Science-Backed. Pet-Approved."
Benefit 1	Vet-formulated with clinical-grade ingredients
Benefit 2	Tested on real pets, loved by thousands
Benefit 3	30-day money-back guarantee
Benefit 4	Free shipping on orders over \$49

Homepage Setup (continued)

Section 7 — Subscription CTA

- ✓ **Heading** — e.g. *"Subscribe & Save 15% Every Order"*
- ✓ **Subtext** — *"Pause or cancel any time. No commitments."*
- ✓ **Button text** — *"Learn About Subscriptions"*
- ✓ **Button link** — </pages/subscriptions>

Section 8 — Testimonials

Three customer review cards. Edit each one:

Field	Example Content
Review text	<i>"My 9-year-old lab is running like a puppy again after 3 weeks on the joint chews!"</i>
Reviewer name	Sarah M., Golden Retriever Mom
Stars	5 (select from dropdown)
Product reviewed	Hip & Joint Chews

Section 9 — Newsletter

- ✓ **Heading** — *"Pet Health Tips, Straight to Your Inbox"*
- ✓ **Subtext** — *"Join 30,000+ pet parents. Unsubscribe any time."*
- ✓ Connect to Shopify Email or your email provider in Marketing settings

Section 10 — Footer

Click **Footer** in the left panel.

- ✓ **Footer menu** — select *Footer menu*
- ✓ **Column 1 label** — *"SHOP"*
- ✓ **Column 2 label** — *"LEARN"*
- ✓ **Column 3 label** — *"SUPPORT"*
- ✓ **Copyright text** — *"© 2025 PawVital. All rights reserved."*
- ✓ **Social links** — add your Instagram, Facebook, TikTok URLs

Mobile preview: Before saving, click the phone icon in the Customizer top bar to check how the homepage looks on mobile. The PawVital theme is fully responsive.

After Configuring All Sections

1 Click Save

Top right button in the Customizer.

2 Exit the Customizer

Click the ← arrow at the top left, or close the tab.

3 View your live store

Click *View your online store* from the Themes page, or go directly to your [.myshopify.com](#) URL.

Store Settings

Before going live, configure these essential settings. Find them all under **Settings** in the sidebar.

Store Details

Settings → **Store details**

- ✓ Store name: *PawVital*
- ✓ Contact email: your real support email
- ✓ Store currency: USD (or your local currency)
- ✓ Store address: required for tax calculations
- ✓ Time zone: set to your local time zone

Payments

Settings → **Payments**

- ✓ Enable **Shopify Payments** (accepts all major cards) — requires bank account
- ✓ Add **PayPal** as an alternative method
- ✓ Optionally add **Shop Pay**, **Apple Pay**, or **Google Pay**

Shipping

Settings → **Shipping and delivery**

- ✓ Add shipping zones (e.g. "United States")
- ✓ Add rate: *Free shipping* with minimum order \$49
- ✓ Add rate: *Standard shipping* — flat rate \$5.99 (under \$49)
- ✓ Optionally add *Express shipping* with a higher rate

Taxes

Settings → **Taxes and duties**

- ✓ Enable *Charge taxes on shipping rates* if required by your location
- ✓ Shopify auto-calculates tax rates for most regions

Notifications (Emails)

[Settings](#) → [Notifications](#)

- ✓ Customize order confirmation, shipping, and refund email templates
- ✓ Add your store logo and brand colors to email templates

Domain

[Settings](#) → [Domains](#)

- ✓ Buy a custom domain through Shopify (e.g. [pawvital.com](#)) or connect one you already own
- ✓ Set your custom domain as the *Primary domain*

Disable Password Protection

[Online Store](#) → [Preferences](#) → [Password protection](#)

New Shopify stores have password protection ON by default. Uncheck "*Restrict access to this online store*" and save when you're ready to go live.

Do not go live until payments and shipping are configured. Customers could place orders that you can't fulfill or charge incorrectly.

Matrixify Bulk Import Shortcut

Instead of adding products, collections, pages, and menus manually one by one — you can import everything at once using a single Excel file and the Matrixify app.

When to use Matrixify: Use it when you want to set up the store quickly with all demo content pre-filled. You can always edit everything after import. Skip this chapter if you prefer to set up the store manually using Chapters 2–6.

What Matrixify Does

The `pawvital-matrixify.xlsx` file contains pre-built sheets for every content type. Matrixify reads the file and creates everything automatically — including fetching images from the internet.

Sheet	Creates	Count
Products	All 8 products with images, variants, tags, descriptions	8
Smart Collections	Auto-collections with rules	10
Custom Collections	Manual collections (Best Sellers, Bundles, etc.)	4
Pages	About, Contact, FAQ, Shipping, Subscriptions pages	5
Blogs / Articles	4 blog posts with images	4
Menus	Main menu + Footer menu with all links	2

Step 1 — Install Matrixify

1 Open Shopify App Store

Admin → Apps → Visit Shopify App Store → search "Matrixify".

2 Install the app

Click *Add app* → accept permissions. The free plan allows up to 10 products per import — enough for the demo.

Step 2 — Import the Excel File

1 Open Matrixify

Admin → Apps → Matrixify.

2 Click "Import"

Click the Import button on the main screen.

3 Upload `pawvital-matrixify.xlsx`

Click *Choose file* → select the Excel file → click **Import**

4 Wait for completion

Matrixify shows live progress. Takes 2–5 minutes. Images are fetched automatically from the internet.

5 Check results

When done, click *View results*. Green = success, red = error. If any images failed, re-run the import — Matrixify retries failed ones.

After Matrixify Import

Matrixify creates all the products, collections, pages, and menus. You still need to:

- ✓ Go to the Customizer and configure homepage sections (Chapter 7)
- ✓ In Header settings → select *Main menu*
- ✓ Replace placeholder images with real product photos
- ✓ Edit page content with your real business information
- ✓ Configure store settings (payments, shipping) — Chapter 8

Time saved: Manual setup (Chapters 2–6) takes approximately 2–4 hours. With Matrixify, the same content is imported in under 10 minutes.

Important: Run the Matrixify import on a fresh store (no existing products). If products already exist, the import uses MERGE mode — it will update matching products rather than create duplicates. This is safe, but check for unwanted changes afterwards.

Go-Live Checklist

Before sharing the store URL with customers, go through this checklist to make sure everything is working correctly.

Content

- ✓ All products added with real photos, descriptions, and pricing
- ✓ All product variants have correct prices and inventory set
- ✓ All collections created and populated with products
- ✓ Main menu and Footer menu configured correctly
- ✓ All pages created: About, Contact, FAQ, Shipping, Subscriptions
- ✓ Blog has at least 1 published post
- ✓ No placeholder "Lorem ipsum" text anywhere on the store

Theme & Homepage

- ✓ PawVital theme published (shows as "Current theme")
- ✓ Announcement bar has real messages
- ✓ Hero section has a real image, heading, and working CTA button
- ✓ Featured Categories section links to correct collections
- ✓ Featured Collection shows real products
- ✓ Testimonials have real (or realistic demo) reviews
- ✓ Footer shows correct menu links and contact info

Store Settings

- ✓ Store name and contact email set correctly
- ✓ Payment provider connected and tested
- ✓ Shipping zones and rates configured
- ✓ Tax settings reviewed for your region
- ✓ Custom domain connected and set as primary
- ✓ Password protection **disabled**
- ✓ Policy pages created (Privacy, Refund, Terms)

Testing

- ✓ Add a product to cart — cart drawer opens and shows item
- ✓ Change quantity in cart — total updates correctly
- ✓ Click Checkout — proceeds to Shopify checkout page

- ✓ Complete a test order using Shopify's Bogus Gateway (test payment)
- ✓ Check order confirmation email arrives correctly
- ✓ Open the store on a real mobile phone — no horizontal scroll
- ✓ Test the search — searching "joint" returns products
- ✓ Test product page accordions — open and close correctly
- ✓ Test contact page — form submits and you receive the email

How to Place a Test Order

[Settings](#) → [Payments](#) → [Manage](#) → [Use Bogus Gateway for testing](#)

At checkout, use card number **1** and any future expiry date. This places a real test order with no actual charge. Cancel or delete the test order afterwards.

YOU'RE READY

Store setup complete.

Once all checklist items are ticked, your PawVital store is ready for customers. Share your domain, connect your marketing channels, and start selling.